THE REFRAME

Sell the decision, not the headline.

The idea — call it **Clarion** — is worth building, but only as an **AI decision-intelligence platform**, not an AI news site. The question a business will pay to answer isn't "what happened in AI today." It's this:

"What changed, why does it matter to my company, and what should we do about it?"

5/10	7/10	9/10
AS AN AI NEWS AGGREGATOR — CROWDED, COPYABLE, HARD TO MONETIZE	AS "WIKIPEDIA FOR AI" — USEFUL, BUT FREE SOURCES COMPETE	AS AN ADOPTION & DECISION PLATFORM — THEY PAY TO DECIDE WHAT, WHY, HOW

THE PROBLEM

Companies aren't short on AI news. They're drowning in it.

Hundreds of models, agents and products ship every month. The coverage explains *what* happened, almost never what it means for *one* company. Leaders can't separate hype from practical value; real use cases sit scattered across vendor pages and consulting decks; comparing options, estimating ROI and weighing risk is slow, manual work.

Every one of those gaps is between an **event** and a **decision**. That gap is the product.

THE SIGNATURE ARTIFACT

Every development becomes one structured card.

This is the wedge and the moat in one object: a consistent **News → Use-Case** format that turns any development into a business decision. Not another feed of articles — a repeatable intelligence structure. Here's a real specimen for the seed vertical.

DEVELOPMENT · 12 SEP 2026 · VERIFIED

VERDICT **Pilot**

New AI yield engine auto-optimizes programmatic ad inventory in real time

BUSINESS SIGNIFICANCE

Sets floor prices and allocates impressions across demand automatically — lifts RPM without manual trafficking.

RELEVANT SEGMENTS

News media · Niche publishers · Streaming

RELEVANT FUNCTIONS

Yield mgmt · Ad operations · Revenue

POSSIBLE USE CASES

Dynamic floor pricing · header-bidding optimization · unsold-inventory allocation

BUSINESS VALUE

Higher RPM / yield; fewer manual ad-ops hours.

ADOPTION COMPLEXITY

Medium

KEY RISKS

Revenue volatility while tuning · SSP lock-in

RECOMMENDATION

Pilot on a slice of remnant inventory; measure RPM uplift against a control group.

EVIDENCE

SSP release notes · independent benchmark · 2 publisher case studies

One template, every update. Consistency is what makes it an intelligence product instead of a blog. It also forces the

discipline that separates fact, vendor claim and platform analysis —
the thing enterprise buyers check for.

THE ENGINE

News in, decisions out.

A reader shouldn't stop at the article. The pipeline carries each development from raw signal to a recommended action mapped to their business.

01
Collect & verify

02
Classify & summarize

03
Map to industry & function

04
Explain business impact

05
Recommend use case & next step

WHERE IT SITS

Between the tools people already trust — but faster and more personal.

The category is validated by who already occupies pieces of it. The opening is a simpler product built specifically around the **adoption decision**.

Wikipedia	Structured knowledge — free, generic, no point of view
Google News	Current developments — volume, no interpretation
G2	Vendor comparisons — reviews, no "so what"
Gartner / Forrester	Research & evaluation — deep, slow, expensive

AlphaSense · CB Insights	Cited research & market intel over large document sets
This platform	**Development → business impact → recommended action, personalized to your industry & function**

Established players prove businesses pay for curated intelligence. None is built narrowly around the fast AI-adoption decision for companies that can't afford Gartner.

MARKET RESEARCH

A large, fast market — with demand created by companies that can't keep up.

Two markets stack here: the AI wave itself, and the **decision-intelligence** layer that helps businesses act on it. Both are large and compounding, and the growth is fastest exactly where the beachhead sits.

$83B → $988B

Global generative-AI market, 2026 → 2035 at 31.6% CAGR.

GM Insights, 2026

~$20B

Decision-intelligence market in 2026, growing ~14% CAGR through 2033.

Grand View · IMARC, 2026

88%

of organizations now use AI in at least one business function.

Enterprise AI surveys, 2025–26

42%

of mid-market firms (50–499 staff) use AI in a process — up from 23% in 2024.

SMB AI adoption data, 2026

41%

annual AI-spend growth in India — the fastest-growing market, ahead of Brazil & Indonesia.

Global AI spend indices, 2026

$10–12B → $17B

India domestic AI revenue, FY26 → 2027 projection.

Nasscom–BCG

The demand isn't hypothetical — it's frustration. Among mid-market buyers, **61% cite cost** as the top barrier to AI, **54% lack expertise**, and the skills gap is the #1 blocker overall

(46%, Deloitte). These are people who know they need AI and don't know where to begin. That confusion is the market — and it exists in every economy, not one.

GLOBAL PRODUCT, INDIA LAUNCH BASE

The intelligence is inherently global: an OpenAI release or a new agent matters to a bank in Mumbai, Munich and Manhattan alike. So the **content and ambition are global from day one** — only distribution and pricing localize. India isn't the target market; it's the **launch base** — cheap curation talent, warm first customers, and the fastest, lowest-cost place to validate the loop before scaling go-to-market outward.

MARKET SIZING

How big is our slice — TAM, SAM, SOM.

Sized global, because the product is. Every figure below states its assumption; treat them as defensible estimates for an internal case, not audited numbers.

TAM · TOTAL ADDRESSABLE

≈ $18–20B

The 2026 global decision-intelligence category we sit inside — every organization worldwide that could pay to turn AI developments into decisions. Growing ~14% CAGR.

Basis: decision-intelligence market, Grand View / IMARC 2026

SAM · SERVICEABLE AVAILABLE

≈ $2.5–3B

The slice we can actually serve early: AI-active mid-market firms + enterprise innovation teams + consulting/service firms, across priority geographies (India, US, UK, EU, SEA, Gulf).

Bottom-up: ~700K target orgs × ~$4K blended ACV

SOM · SERVICEABLE OBTAINABLE · 3 YR

≈ $12–18M ARR

Realistic beachhead capture in three years: a few thousand paying accounts won from the India launch base plus English-speaking mid-market, via freemium conversion and consultancy resale.

Bottom-up: ~4,000 paying accounts × ~$4K blended ACV (see pricing ladder)

Bars are illustrative, not drawn to scale — SOM is a fraction of a percent of TAM, which is the point: enormous headroom, and a first target small enough to actually hit. The lever on every number is **blended ACV**, which is exactly why monetization geography (below) matters more than launch geography.

COMPETITOR RESEARCH

The incumbents are deep, slow, and priced for the Fortune 500.

Every adjacent player validates that businesses pay for curated intelligence. None is built around the fast AI-adoption decision, and none is affordable to a mid-market team. Their price is our opening.

PLAYER	WHAT THEY SELL	ANNUAL PRICE	BUILT FOR	WHERE THEY LEAVE THE GAP
Gartner / Forrester	Analyst research & advisory	$30K–$500K+ advisory $3–7K/hr	Large enterprise	Slow, generic to your firm, unaffordable for mid-market
AlphaSense	Cited market & enterprise-intel search	$10K–$20K/seat $7.5B val · $700M ARR	Finance & large enterprise	Search over documents — not "what should we do"

PLAYER	WHAT THEY SELL	ANNUAL PRICE	BUILT FOR	WHERE THEY LEAVE THE GAP
CB Insights	Tech-market & company intelligence	$30K–$100K+	VCs, corp-strategy teams	Market data, no adoption recommendation
G2	Crowd vendor reviews	Freemium	Software buyers	Reviews, no interpretation, no ROI or fit
Deloitte & consultancies	Use-case libraries + engagements	Engagement fees	Enterprise clients	Consulting-gated, not self-serve or continuous
AI newsletters / news	Developments & launches	Free–low	Everyone	Headlines, zero personalization or "so what"

The market splits into two camps: expensive, deep intelligence (Gartner, AlphaSense, CB Insights) and free, shallow news (G2, newsletters). Nobody occupies the middle — affordable, personalized, decision-first.

THE GAP WE EXPLOIT

The bottleneck isn't information. It's the decision.

95% of enterprise generative-AI pilots show **no measurable ROI** in 2026 — despite $30–40B spent on them.

88%
of AI pilots never reach production

42%
of firms abandoned most AI initiatives in 2025 (up from 17%

56%
saw neither revenue gain nor cost saving (PwC)

	in 2024)	

The research is blunt about the cause: the failure is **organizational, not technical** — unclear definitions of success, chasing technology instead of business outcomes, weak fit into real workflows, fading executive sponsorship. In other words, companies aren't short on AI capability or AI news. They're short on the **judgment layer** that turns a development into the *right* action for their specific business.

> THE OPENING
>
> Every incumbent sells **more information**. The 95% didn't fail for lack of information — they failed at translation and decision. The unbuilt product is a **decision layer, priced for the mid-market**, that answers the one question the failures got wrong: "what should *we* do about this, and where do we start?" That is precisely what the News → Use-Case card and the wedge below deliver.

THE WEDGE

Ship one loop end-to-end — not five products.

The original plan listed five components. That's a full platform, not a first version. Rebuilding Gartner is how this dies. Ship a **single loop** that works completely, then earn the right to add the rest.

> THE CORRECTED MVP
>
> Pick an industry + function → get the 5 developments that actually matter → each rendered as the News → Use-Case card → one weekly executive brief. Everything else — ROI estimator, readiness assessment, opportunity finder, watchlists — is **roadmap**, not launch.

```
Select industry → Select function → Name the problem →
Get developments + proven use cases + next steps
```

01

Curated developments

Classified, de-noised, dated.

02

Use-case library

By industry and department.

03

"Why it matters to you"

The card, tailored.

04

Weekly executive brief

Leadership-ready summary.

THE HONEST PART

On day one, there is no moat. Be clear about that.

An LLM can summarize news in a weekend, so summaries alone build nothing defensible. The temptation is to call the AI output "proprietary." It isn't. Defensibility here is **human-curated and time-accrued** — it cannot be generated, only earned:

- → **A proprietary use-case taxonomy** — the classification, not the text
- → **Verified implementation examples** — real deployments, human-checked
- → **Vendor & capability datasets** — structured, maintained, current
- → **Adoption benchmarks** — what actually worked, by segment
- → **Claims-vs-outcomes tracking** — the compounding asset; every quarter of history a competitor can't clone

SAY IT OUT LOUD

The moat is curation labor plus a track record that only time produces. Early on you win on focus and speed, not defensibility — and that's fine, if you know it.

FIRST CUSTOMER

Pick one buyer. The two obvious ones want opposite things.

Three segments are viable — but building for all three at once produces a muddy product. Mid-market buyers want to be *told what to do*; consultancies want *raw intelligence to resell*. Those are different products. Choose.

A **Mid-market companies starting AI adoption**

Need practical guidance, can't afford Gartner or a big consulting engagement. Want the answer, not the raw feed. **Recommended beachhead.**

B **Consulting & tech-service firms**

Use it for client research, use-case discovery, proposals, competitive intel. Want the raw material — a different UX and pricing.

C **Enterprise innovation / transformation teams**

Continuous monitoring, vendor evaluation, portfolio planning. Highest value, longest sales cycle — a later expansion.

RECOMMENDATION

Build for **mid-market leaders who know they need AI but not where to begin** — the buyer who wants the answer, not the raw feed. That one choice fixes the data model, journey, MVP and pricing. Expand to consultancies (resale) and enterprise innovation teams once the loop earns its keep.

SEPARATE LAUNCH FROM MONETIZATION

Validate in India, monetize globally. India is the cheapest, fastest place to build the curation engine and win your first design partners — but it's also the most price-sensitive, so it may not be where you prove willingness-to-pay. Draw your paid tiers

around a higher-ACV market (US / UK / EU / Gulf) from the start, with an India entry price as the on-ramp. Don't let the launch base cap the pricing model.

SEED WEDGE

Start narrow: mid-market digital publishers.

The library can't be seeded everywhere at once — depth is the moat, and depth means picking one vertical and owning it. The seed is **digital publishers**, chosen on access, not abstract market size: it's the founder's home turf, which means the fastest interviews, the warmest intros, and the most concrete cards.

- **Deepest credibility** — real fluency in inventory, yield and ad ops. At seed stage, access beats TAM.
- **Existential AI pull** — AI search and Overviews are gutting referral traffic, AI content is commoditizing inventory. "What do we do about AI" is survival here, not a nice-to-have — the fastest path to a yes.
- **An ownable category** — nobody owns "the AI decision platform for digital publishers." Narrow enough to build a genuinely deep, defensible library fast.
- **Concrete by default** — RPMs, fill rates, yield: the cards write themselves specific, never generic.

SEED · NOW

Digital Publishers

Revenue & ad operations — the functions being reshaped by AI right now.

- Inventory mgmt
- Yield mgmt
- Ad operations

ACV: entry-priced on-ramp

EXPAND · 2

Supply Chain & Logistics

Operationally a cousin of yield management — the engine transfers. Safe, measurable ROI; easy pilots.

- Ops
- Doc automation
- Forecasting

ACV: mid

EXPAND · 3

Fintech

Highest ACV — but tech-forward builders with the highest trust bar. Enter once the product is mature and trusted.

- Risk
- Compliance
- KYC

ACV: highest

THE ONE RISK, AND THE ANSWER

Publishers are margin-squeezed, so willingness-to-pay is the question mark. But **existential pain unlocks budget in a way efficiency gains never do** — a business being killed by AI will pay to understand AI. Price the publisher tier as an entry on-ramp, prove the loop, then climb the ACV ladder into logistics and fintech.

PRICE POSITIONING

Above a newsletter, a tenth of Gartner.

Competitor pricing exposes the same gap as an empty band. Premium research for one person tops out near **$750/yr**; real enterprise research *starts* near **$10K**. Between them — affordable decision intelligence for a team — there is almost nothing.

$0	Free — AI newsletters, G2, Google News
$150–750/yr	Premium newsletters — Stratechery, The Information
$240–480/yr	Prosumer AI — Perplexity Pro / Enterprise

$400 → $10K	**The gap — affordable, personalized decision intelligence · your zone**
$10K–20K/seat	AlphaSense
$30K–100K/yr	CB Insights
$30K–500K+	Gartner / Forrester

Sources (2026): Stratechery, The Information, Perplexity published pricing; AlphaSense, CB Insights, Gartner/Forrester via Vendr / CostBench. Per-seat figures annualized.

THE PRICING THESIS

Sit just above the premium-newsletter line so a Professional seat is an easy yes, and land the Business tier at **~$3–6K/yr** — an order of magnitude under the $30K+ research it replaces. That is the whole promise expressed as a number. A realistic tier mix gives a **blended ACV of ~$4K**, which is what anchors the SAM and SOM. The one trap: if it reads as a pricier newsletter, buyers anchor to $400 and you lose — the personalization, recommendation and card are what justify the step up.

MONEY

People read news for free. They pay for decisions.

Freemium, with the paid line drawn at personalization, comparison and recommendation — the things a free feed can't give.

FREE

$0

- Selected news
- Basic explainers
- Limited use cases

PROFESSIONAL

$30–50/seat/mo

- Personalized feed
- Vendor comparisons
- Watchlists & alerts
- Individual / small team

BUSINESS · CORE

$3K–6K/yr

- Everything in Professional
- Team seats & exec briefs
- Downloadable reports
- ~1/10th of Gartner's price

ENTERPRISE

$15K–40K/yr

- Custom taxonomies
- Internal-knowledge integration
- Executive briefings
- Undercuts CB Insights / AlphaSense

ADVISORY ADD-ON

Engagement

- Readiness assessment
- Use-case prioritization
- Implementation support

Price the tiers around a higher-ACV market (US / UK / EU / Gulf) with a discounted India entry price as the on-ramp — purchasing-power pricing, not a global flat rate. It can become a lead engine for AI implementation services later, but only if recommendations stay credible and never read as disguised sales. The day it feels like a pitch, the intelligence is worthless.

WHAT KILLS IT

Four failure modes to design against.

1 **Going too broad**

"Everything about AI for every company" is unbuildable as v1. The wedge above is the antidote.

2 **Content as commodity**

If it's all AI-summarized, it's cloned in a weekend. Defensibility lives in curation and the outcomes track record.

3 **Trust & accuracy**

Enterprise expects citations, dates, fact-vs-claim-vs-analysis separation, human review, transparent scoring. Build it in from card one.

4 **Content licensing**

Summarize and link — never copy full articles or paid reports. That line is legal, not stylistic.

THE ONE DECISION NOW

A global platform, built from India, seeded with digital publishers.

The shape is settled: sell decisions not headlines, ship one loop not five, build the moat through curation over time. Launch cheaply from India, price around a higher-ACV market, and seed the use-case library with — inventory, yield and ad ops — before expanding to logistics and fintech. The strategy is decided. The next move is to build the loop for that one vertical and put it in front of ten publishers.

Discover what matters. Understand the business impact. Decide what to adopt.

CLARION · SIGNAL THROUGH THE NOISE

Clarion — "Signal through the noise." Strategy memo refined from source analysis. Market & competitor figures (2026): GM Insights, Grand View, IMARC, Nasscom–BCG, Deloitte, PwC, MIT "GenAI Divide", Sacra/GetLatka (AlphaSense), Vendr/CostBench (Gartner, Forrester, CB Insights); Stratechery, The Information, Perplexity (published pricing). Ranges are indicative; verify before external use.